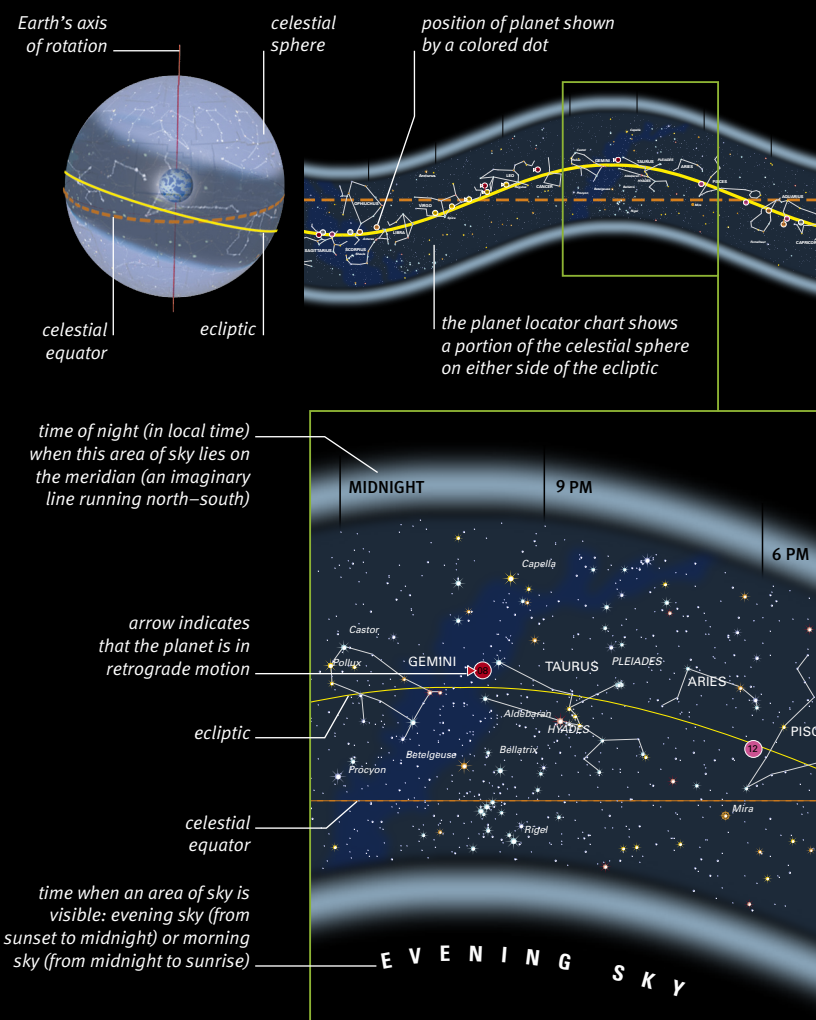


Monthly sky guide

Some constellations are always in our sky, while others appear and disappear during the course of the year. Your view of the night sky and the highlights that each month brings are described in this section. For each month, a Special Events table lists events that vary from year to year, while the positions of the naked-eye planets are shown on a locator chart.



Planet locator charts

These charts show the positions of Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn. They give the planets' positions in relation to the constellations along the ecliptic—the part of the sky in which they are always found. The view portrayed here and described in the accompanying text is for 10 pm midmonth (11 pm at the start of the month, and 9 pm at the end). When daylight saving time is observed, add one hour to these times.

Using the charts

Each planet is represented by a different-colored dot (the key is repeated in the guide for each month), and the number inside the dot refers to a particular year. Once you have identified the constellation in which the planet you are looking for can be found, use the planisphere to locate it in the night sky and the constellation cards to get a more detailed view.

An ever-changing scene

There is always something new to see in the night sky. As Earth spins, the stars that take center stage at the start of the evening are replaced by fresh ones from the east, which in turn sink to the west before the night is over.